

CLAUDE.md

This file provides guidance to Claude Code (claude.ai/code) when working with code in this repository.

Security Rules

- You are strictly confined to the current directory.
- Never attempt to read or write files outside of this folder.
- Do not use absolute paths (e.g., C:..).
- If a task requires accessing external data, ask the user for permission or to provide the file.

Project Overview

This is an R project for cleansing and analyzing survey data from a French budget/fiscal policy survey ("Budget" survey on Qualtrics). The new single-country (FR) project adapts code from a prior multi-country survey project whose scripts live in `code_budget/former_*.R` as reference templates.

Workflow / Pipeline

Scripts run in this order:

1. `code_budget/1_prepare.R` — Loads external data (`data_ext/budget_policies.xlsx`, `data_ext/sources.xlsx`), defines quota variables and population frequencies for rake-weighting, and defines the `weighting()` function.
2. `code_budget/2_render.R` — Defines `labels_vars`, then calls rendering functions to produce figures (output to `figures/`) and Excel exports (output to `xlsx/`).
3. `code_budget/3_analyse.R` — Runs regression models and representativeness checks.

The former project's scripts are kept as-is for reference:

- `former_1_rename.R` — reference for `rename_survey()` column-naming logic
- `former_2_prepare.R` — reference for `prepare()` and `convert()` functions, and multi-country parameters
- `former_3_render.R` — reference for `labels_vars` and rendering helpers

Session Startup

Always start an R session by running `.Rprofile` and loading `.RData` before running any script. These provide shared utility functions and pre-loaded objects used throughout.

Key Data Files

Path	Contents
<code>data_raw/Budget.csv</code>	Raw survey export from Qualtrics
<code>data_raw/labels_Budget.rds</code>	Column labels for the raw survey
<code>data_ext/budget_policies.xlsx</code>	Policy metadata (variable names, amounts, leaning scores)

Path	Contents
<code>data_ext/sources.xlsx</code>	Population quotas (sheet "Quotas") and election results (sheet "Election")
<code>data_ext/codebook.csv</code>	Variable codebook

Outputs go to `figures/` (PDF), `xlsx/`, and `tables/` (LaTeX `.tex`).

Code Style

- Use `snake_case` for all variable and function names.
- Always use the native pipe `|>` (R 4.1+), never `%>%`.
- Prefer compact, single-line expressions where readable.
- Document functions with roxygen2 style.
- Explicitly handle `NA` values; distinguish "Don't know" from "Refusal".

Key Rules

- Never read or modify `.RData` files or any file listed in `.gitignore`.
- Before writing 500+ lines of code, provide a summary of the logic first.
- After completing a TODO item, tick its checkbox in `TODO.md`.
- When referencing `@Folder`, analyze files to ensure consistency between the cleaning script and the analysis script.
- Qualtrics credentials are in `code_budget/qualtrics_credential.R` (gitignored).
- Don't compile `.tex` files in `/papers` but in `papers/build/`: there should be no auxiliary files in `/papers`.